

**Circular for all branches and offices
Issued by Operations Department, Head Office**

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Custody of various keys.

We all are aware that keys have utmost importance in banking service, hence the responsibility of key holders also becomes very immense. Being the representative of the bank along with trustee of the customer's money and valuables, the key holders should consider the security of keys as important as the security of cash.

Security of keys is an important and sensitive task which is directly related to the security of the Bank. **Ultimate compliance of guidelines issued along with proper vigilance is necessary in this regard.**

Following the amalgamation of the three banks, it is necessary to issue appropriate guidelines to ensure uniformity.

With the objective of the security of keys of cash vault, cash cabin, branch premises, safe deposit locker etc. in branches all staff are advised to scrupulously follow below mentioned guidelines regarding holding and handling of different sort of keys on case to case basis:

Case 1: Where BH & One Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash) or One Customer Service Associate is posted. (Single Officer Branch)	
Branch Head	1) Premises Key one set 2) Cash safe Key A-1 3) Cash Safe (Left & Right Drawer keys one set) 4) FRFC one set 5) Master Key of Cash Safe & FRFC 6) Security form Almirah one Set
Senior Customer Service Associate or Customer Service Associate	1) Premises Key one Set 2) Cash safe Key B-1 3) FRFC One set 4) Security form Almirah one Set
For Safe custody: Should be kept at the authorised Branch.	1) Premises Key One Set 2) Duplicate Key of Cash safe A-1 & B-1 3) Duplicate Cash Safe (Left & Right Drawer keys) 4) Duplicate Key FRFC one set 5) Duplicate Master Key of Cash Safe & FRFC
Case 2: Branches having BH and One or more officers with One Senior Customer Service Associate or One Customer Service Associate (Cash)	
Branch Head	1) Premises Key one set 2) FRFC one set 3) Cash Safe (Left & Right Drawer keys one set) 4) Security form Almirah key one set 5) Gold Safe Key one set

उत्तर प्रदेश ग्रामीण बैंक

Uttar Pradesh Gramin Bank

	6) Master key of Cash Safe, FRFC & Gold safe.
Officer	1) Premises Key one set 2) Cash Safe A-1 3) FRFC one set 4) Security form Almirah one Set 5) Gold Safe Key one set
Senior Customer Service Associate or Customer Service Associate	1) Premises Key one set 2) Cash Safe B-1
For Safe custody: Should be kept at the authorised Branch.	1) Duplicate Key of Cash safe A-1 & B-1 2) Duplicate Cash Safe (Left & Right Drawer keys) 3) Duplicate Key FRFC one set 4) Duplicate Gold safe key one set 5) Duplicate Master Key of Cash Safe, FRFC & Gold Safe.
Case 3: Branches having BH and One or more officers with Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash) & Customer Service Associate	
Branch Head	1) Premises Key one set 2) FRFC one set 3) Cash Safe (Left & Right Drawer keys one set) 4) Security form Almirah key one set 5) Gold Safe Key one set 6) Master key of Cash Safe, FRFC & Gold safe.
Officer	1) Premises Key one set 2) Cash Safe A-1 3) FRFC one set 4) Security form Almirah one Set 5) Gold Safe Key one set
Senior Customer Service Associate	1) Cash Safe B-1
Customer Service Associate	1) Premises Key one set
For Safe custody: Should be kept at the authorised Branch.	1) Duplicate Key of Cash safe A-1 & B-1 2) Duplicate Cash Safe (Left & Right Drawer keys) 3) Duplicate Key FRFC one set 4) Duplicate Gold safe key one set 5) Duplicate Master Key of Cash Safe, FRFC & Gold Safe.
In all above cases	
If Senior Office Assistant (Office Attendant) is posted in the branch.	If Senior Office Assistant posted in the branch, only one set of premises keys should be handed over to him/her.

c) Duplicate Keys:

i) Duplicate keys of cash safe and cash room should not be left in the safe or cash room under any circumstances. Duplicate keys of safes, documents, securities cabinets etc. should be kept in sealed packets in safe custody of authorised Branch with the permission of the Regional Office. While keeping duplicate keys in safe custody, oil/ Vaseline should be applied on the keys to

प्रधान कार्यालय: द्वितीय एवं तृतीय तल, एनबीसीसी कमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स, वरदान खंड, गोमती नगर एक्सटेंशन, लखनऊ - 226010
Head Office: 2nd and 3rd floor, NBCC Commercial Complex, Vardan Khand, Gomti Nagar Extension, Lucknow - 226010
email- ho@barodauprrb.co.in

prevent rusting. The keys should be separately wrapped in polythene or oil paper, thereafter packed in tin or cardboard container signed by the joint custodians and sealed properly. A duplicate copy of the list of keys signed by the joint custodians should be enclosed with the respective safe custody receipt.

ii) Branches should ensure that the duplicate keys which are to be sent for safe custody are sent only with the Branch Head, Officer In-charge and Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash). The safe custody receipt should be kept safe in a cabinet outside the strong room in the custody of the Branch Head.

iii) The details of safe custody receipt received from authorised Branch must be entered in the key register.

2) Instructions on Safe Deposit Lockers:

i) Custody of Keys of Safe Deposit Cabinets/Lockers:

- The safe deposit vault/locker should be kept overnight under the joint charge of the full time custodian (officer in charge of the vault/locker in his absence) and the Branch Head/Officer In-charge/any other officer.
- Where cash safe and safe deposit locker cabinets are kept in the same strong room, there should normally be an exclusive counter for cash safe which should be under the joint control of Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash) and the Branch Head/Officer-in-Charge and the custody of the strong room lockers should be under the joint control of the Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash) along with the Branch Head/Officer-in-Charge or either of the Cash Custodians.
- If separate counter cannot be provide due to lack of adequate space, the strong room should be placed under the joint charge of the Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash) and Branch Head/Officer In-charge/any other officer who looks after the locker facility.
 - While keeping the duplicate keys of the safe deposit room/locker in safe custody of authorised Branch, care must be taken to deposit them in a separate packet with the instruction that the packet be delivered jointly to the Branch Head and the Custodian. For this a separate safe custody receipt should be obtained and kept in a separate file.
- The key of lockers issued to customers by branches which are to be retained in the custody of the locker custodian designated by the branch, should be kept in an empty locker after entering all the keys serially in the prescribed register, which should always be kept duly sealed in the joint custody of the Branch Head / Officer-in-Charge and Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash) / Custodian.

ii) Empty Lockers:

The keys of all empty lockers should be kept in the joint custody of the Branch Head/Officer in-charge and Senior Customer Service Associate (Cash)/Custodian duly sealed. The "pliers" for applying the seal should also be kept in joint custody.

The list of keys and their holding position should be maintained in key register, also the key register must be checked on quarterly basis and a certificate in this regard should be sent to the Regional Office.

3) Instructions regarding branch premises Keys:

Computers, photocopy machines, printers, currency counting machines and other costly machinery are kept in the open banking hall of the branch, and hence custody of keys of branch premises is of utmost importance. For this purpose the following guidelines should be followed:

प्रधान कार्यालय: द्वितीय एवं तृतीय तल, एनबीसीसी कमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स, वरदान खंड, गोमती नगर एक्सटेंशन, लखनऊ - 226010
Head Office: 2nd and 3rd floor, NBCC Commercial Complex, Vardan Khand, Gomti Nagar Extension, Lucknow - 226010
email- ho@barodauprb.co.in

i) To ensure security of bank operations the keys of branch premises should be kept with a responsible officer and the keys should be available for opening branch premises, cleaning or other emergencies.

ii) It has also been observed that many times branch premises are not opened at the scheduled time as the key holders are on leave or have to go on leave suddenly due to some unavoidable reasons, thereby affecting customer service and tarnishing the image of the bank.

iii) As above, the branches may ensure strict compliance of the guidelines regarding retention of keys of the premises.

- Where the key-holding person (Other than the Branch Head) avails leave, the Branch Head shall authorize some other Officer/Customer Service Associate in writing to keep the keys till the permanent holder rejoins his post.
- Whenever the Branch Head avails leave, his keys should be handed over to the Acting Branch Head in writing.
- The branches should also ensure that the branch is necessarily opened on time and the keys of the branch premises are not in the possession of unauthorized person(s) in any circumstances.
- The branch should be cleaned up in presence of an Officer/ Senior Customer Service Associate/ Customer Service Associate so authorized by the Branch Head.
- At the beginning of holidays branches & offices ensure that all exits/entries/ window /doors in the branch / office are locked and secured.

4) Loss of cash key:

(i) If cash key, either with the Head Cashier or Branch Manager/Joint Manager is lost, immediately protective action should be taken by locking the cash safe with Master key.

(ii) Duplicate cash keys from the authorized Branch should be brought.

(iii) Cash safe should then be opened in presence of joint custodians and cash counted to tally with the cash balances recorded in the cash balance book. Loss of cash key be also recorded in Key Register.

(iv) Loss of cash key with the circumstances in which it is lost should be immediately reported to Regional Office and instructions be sought.

(v) The manufacturers of cash safe should be contacted urgently and the lock should be changed. The fresh set of keys be obtained and new key numbers noted in the Key Register.

(vi) Duplicate set of new keys must be immediately sent for safe custody as authorized Branch.

(vii) Similar procedure may be followed if any attempt to tamper with cash safe/lock is noticed except the fact that bringing of duplicate cash key may not be necessary. However, the cash safe lock should be got invariably replaced by the manufacturers of safe and till such time Master key should be continued to be operated.

(viii) The keys should be kept with the person and not in drawers etc.

5) Guidelines for Cheque Drop Box Keys:

The "Cheque Drop Box" should be kept locked under dual control of two authorized employees and should be opened regularly every day in the presence of both the authorized employees. The register for cheque drop boxes should record the date, time of opening of the box, number of cheques drawn from it and should be signed by both the authorized employees. If any

उत्तर प्रदेश ग्रामीण बैंक

Uttar Pradesh Gramin Bank

unsent/incomplete cheque is received from the cheque drop box, the same should also be entered in the register and branches should ensure that the same is sent to the customer's base branch or to the customer.

Note: Branch Head and Inspecting officer must ensure that all the keys are exchanged during their branch inspection period and its information is entered in key register and duly signed by Branch Head and Inspecting officer at prescribed place.

Please bring the contents of the circular to the notice of all branches and offices and ensure strict compliance of the given instructions.

Yours sincerely,


(Ghanshyam Singh)
General Manager

